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G50V is a gaming notebook launched by ASUS and it comes with an Nvidia GeForce 9700M GT graphics processor

OCZ NIA

The Real Mind Game

What is the future of gaming? Can it evolve to an extent that it surpasses the use of a keyboard or mouse? These are the questions that the OCZ NIA that we have with us can answer. NIA is the acronym for Neural Impulse Actuator and is a device with advanced technology that claims to read your brainwaves and helps you improve your gameplay.

The NIA is a band that you put on your head with three diamond-shaped sensors on the front that come in contact with your forehead. This head band is attached to the NIA box that reads and interprets your brain activity which in turn is connected to the PC via a USB cable. The NIA also detects muscle movements such as clenching your teeth or raising an eyebrow, or even your glance. Alpha brain signals are associated to images and what you watch while beta brain signals kick in when you start to think logically.

The NIA does allow you to control your character's movement within a game, such as *Quake 3* or *Unreal Tournament*, without using the keyboard or mouse. However, it has its limitations as the technology is



fairly new. Instead, OCZ encourages the use of the NIA along with your keyboard and mouse to help increase your reaction time within the game that you play.

The software provided with the NIA is where you calibrate the device to your needs. The calibration section is mainly for muscle movements and is done by staring at a gyroscope displayed on the screen. The BrainFingers section is where you can view your alpha and beta signals and your glance activity. You will also be required to tweak your key presses in accordance with the different features of the NIA. You could set the movement of your character through glance, firing your weapon with muscle movement and maybe even reload the weapon through the alpha and beta signals. Again these settings will need to be worked on till you get the right combi-

nation. To test your settings, you can try out a simple game of Pong which comes along with the software.

Even after calibrating the NIA, do not expect immediate results as you will need to completely change the way you play before you see results. If you are an average gamer and just like to play for fun, this really might not be your cup of tea.

Requirements:

Windows XP & Vista (32 & 64 bit), 1 GHz CPU, 512 MB Memory, USB 2.0 Recommended.

Ratings

Features: 9
Performance: 6
Build quality: 8.5
Value for money: 7.5
Overall: 7.5

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ASUS ENGTX285 TOP

Slightly overclocked TOP

ASUS is a company known to manufacture hardware that satisfy the craving needs of gamers and overclockers alike. We received an over-clocked version of the GeForce GTX 285 - the ASUS ENGTX285 TOP.

The ASUS GeForce ENGTX285 TOP's core runs at 670MHz, 22MHz faster than the stock. Also the memory clock is 116

MHz faster at 2600 MHz and the shader runs at 1550 MHz, making it 74 MHz faster than stock.

We benchmarked this card in DX10 with 4 GB of DDR2 RAM and an Intel QX9650 @ 3.0 Ghz and found that it managed to match up to the FPS in F.E.A.R., in comparison to the ZOTAC over-clocked version. But

when it came to games such as *Company of Heroes*, *Doom 3*, *Unreal Tournament 3* and *Crysis* it fell short by a few. Lastly in *3D Mark Vantage* it did perform well and gave us a score of 14,675 with a GPU score of 12,065, but this too wasn't enough to beat the GTX 285 Amp!

The ASUS GTX 285 is very good and one of the fastest cards around but it doesn't beat any records here.

If you are a person who does look at faster clocks and are willing to spend only the same amount of money, then you need to look for another brand.



Specifications:

Engine clock: 670 MHz, Shader clock: 1.55 GHz, Memory clock: 2.6 GHz (1.3 GHz DDR3), Memory interface: 512-bit

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 8
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 7
Overall: 8

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